SCHOLASTIC SCOPE

Punctuating Compound Sentences
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Commas in Compound Sentences

A compound sentence is made up of two independent clauses. Here's how to punctuate a compound sentence correctly.

An independent clause is a group of words that could stand on its own as a sentence.

Use a comma before a conjunction (*for, and, nor, but, or, yet, so*) to join two independent clauses.

For example:

Arielle said she would be here, but I haven't seen her.

My sister just bought a new car, and now she wants to buy a motorcycle.

Chris accidentally left his bagel at home, so he's getting pizza.

The underlined phrases above are independent clauses. To form a compound sentence, they must be connected by a comma and a conjunction.

Directions: Add the missing commas to the sentences below.

1. I was planning to ride my bike but it's pouring outside.

2. The milk your father left on the table smelled kind of fishy so I threw it away.

3. Selma wants to train for the big race but she pulled a muscle in her calf yesterday.

4. Marissa wants to take a trip to Europe and she wants to book her flights soon.

5. I went fishing with my dad last weekend but we didn't catch anything.

Directions: Rewrite each set of independent clauses as a single compound sentence. Be sure to use commas and coordinating conjunctions to join the two independent clauses.

6. Paige and Lorenzo disagree about almost everything. They are really good friends.

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7. I stayed home with the flu for four days last week. I have a lot of work to do to catch up.

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